Assignment 1d: AI Collaboration and Career Futures

Harvey Chowdhury
MTEC 4502 - Career and Portfolio Seminar
Dr. David B. Smith
October 14, 2026

1. Career evidence supplied to AI

My Assignment 1b investigated AI automation and interactive experiences through four U.S. creative-technology advertisements: Kyndryl Associate Creative Technologist, Amazon Design Technologist II, NEXT/NOW Creative Technologist AI, and Kyndryl Senior Lead Creative Technologist [J1-J4]. The comparison covered an entry-level role, a role requiring two or more years of experience, a role without stated seniority, and a senior lead role. Prototyping, integration, documentation, and collaboration were recurring themes in my analysis, but the advertisements describe different work. They do not establish that every role fits an automation-focused career.

My 1c skills chart identified programming, interactive web development, and systematic testing as important gaps. Its numbers are subjective self-ratings and interpreted development targets, not employer scores. My SWOT identifies troubleshooting, AI configuration, hardware experimentation, and learning from mistakes as strengths. It also identifies limited independent programming, incomplete testing evidence, time constraints, and changing tools as weaknesses or threats. Hardware suggests a possible direction to investigate, it does not establish professional device-integration competence.

The conversation clarified that automation and integration attract me most. I imagine Donna as a virtual assistant with a personality that helps manage emails, tasks, technology, and eventually home systems. The Jarvis comparison describes my ambition, not an existing capability. My previous email workflow worked, but it is now broken after a system update. I reported that experience to AI no diagnostic logs or cause of failure were established in this exchange. An n8n email-workflow rebuild is a proposed next project, not a completed replacement.

My starting constraints remain the previously recorded 3-4 project hours weekly, a normal total AI budget of $20-$60 monthly, school and family priorities, and expected graduation in May 2028. These are planning constraints rather than measured outcomes. I have not selected a final job title, measured an efficiency improvement, or verified a complete home-assistant system.

Previous work and visuals

- Assignment 1b: strategic framework and job-market comparison
- Assignment 1c: research, visual interpretation, and sources
- Skills-gap chart
- SWOT matrix

The employer sources and their existing Zotero item links are listed in Section 6.

2. Selective AI interaction record: strategy

System: OpenClaw, addressed as Donna, Multi-Harness Agents on paperclip. Using multi models as to the task in hand. no version number is inferred. **Exchange dates:** October 12 and October 14, 2026. Excerpts below preserve the quoted wording. Summaries and later revisions are explicitly labeled.

Initial request and strategy questions - October 12

My initial request, excerpt:

> *Bring up my next assignment and do a full audit of the repos and zotero repo before we begin. Let's start doing 1D. Make an end goal, make a full plan from first to finish about completing 1D. Let's go through it together as we talk to each other to get everything we need before we execute it.*

My instruction to begin, excerpt:

> *Yes, let's execute. Automate the documentation formating and submision. Also, as you do it, run a system audit to check if any new implementations of new skill broke anything last night.*

The AI used the existing 1b and 1c material as context. These were the actual starting instructions, rather than a later reconstruction of the instructor's sample prompt.

AI's initial strategy challenge, excerpt:

> *The first weakness worth examining is scope: developing interactive websites and dependable automations could compete for your limited project time. One small, finished project may provide stronger evidence than several unfinished experiments.*

AI's questions, excerpt:

> *Which direction attracts you more right now - interactive web/design technology or automation/integration - and why?*
>
> *Do you accept my suggestion to focus on one small project first, or do you disagree?*

My follow-up, excerpts:

> *What attracts me more is automation and integration.*
>
> *And secondly, I do accept your suggestion to focus on a small project, something like a small N8N workflow automation stuff, if that is eligible.*

I explained that the project should let Donna compose and send emails while identifying itself as my assistant. This was my proposed direction, not a claim that the rebuilt workflow already exists.

Correcting the project status - October 12

The AI asked whether Donna's email workflow already worked. My earlier reflection described a working system, so its present status needed clarification.

My correction, excerpt:

> *No, because the old workflow that I had, which was working, is broken since I updated my entire system. So I need to start everything from scratch.*

AI's observation selected for verification, excerpt:

> *a successful demonstration does not establish that an integration will keep working after system changes.*

Verification: My first-hand report supports this limited observation: a workflow that previously worked is no longer working following a system change. It does not identify the technical cause or prove that a replacement will be more efficient. My October 14 response accepts reliability as a priority while qualifying how I learn it, that decision is analyzed in Section 4.

3. Selective AI interaction record: scenarios and correction

Initial scenario proposal - October 12

After I prioritized automation, the AI proposed two conditional three-to-five-year scenarios: digital workflow integration and home/physical-system integration. It connected the first to finished workflows, API knowledge, and testing, and the second to those foundations plus device integration and troubleshooting. These were AI-generated possibilities, not verified job forecasts.

AI's follow-up question, excerpt:

> *What would you challenge or change in these scenarios? For example, would focusing first on digital workflows feel useful - or too far removed from the home assistant you actually want?*

My response, excerpt:

> *focusing on the digital workflows does feel useful because these are kind of like the foundations and basics of what I envision for the future. So I don't think it's far off or completely out of the ballpark of what I'm trying to do eventually.*

AI's revised reasoning, excerpt:

> *digital workflows are a foundation for your home system, so choosing them first does not mean abandoning that ambition.*

This response rejects the suggestion that the smaller digital project might be disconnected from my goal. The revised scenarios distinguish types of career work and technical environments, while recognizing that they can share a starting project.

Challenging the learning sequence - October 12-14

AI's question - October 12, excerpt:

> *do you accept that reliability and understanding should come before optimization - or would you prioritize rebuilding for efficiency first?*

My response - October 14, excerpts:

> *I believe reliability and understanding should come first in order to build a much stronger and efficient system.*
>
> *most of the understanding and reliability comes from rebuilding it or building something new*
>
> *I don't believe I understand your question perfectly*
>
> *And I don't just do anything on a whim. I do my research and everything, and then do it. And I still make mistakes because I try to do it a lot.*

I supported the goal of reliability but challenged the implied sequence. Researching and building are how I develop understanding I do not expect to know everything before starting.

AI's revised response - October 14, excerpt:

> *My question made learning and reliability sound like competing choices. Your answer clarifies that you build reliability by researching, rebuilding, making mistakes, and understanding them.*

Revised recommendation, summary: Start with the email workflow as a bounded rebuild. Research the approach, build and test it, investigate failures, and keep explanations of what changed. Broader experiments can inform later versions expansion and efficiency claims should be supported by results. This recommendation reconciles learning through construction with a manageable first deliverable.

4. Analysis and decision

I started this exchange with a clearer interest than a clear job title. Automation and integration attract me because I want Donna to become a virtual assistant that connects with my technology and eventually my home. I still care about my portfolio, but interactive web design is not the main reason I keep experimenting. Explaining that to the AI helped separate the work I want to do from the way I present it.

The AI suggested focusing on one small project instead of developing several directions at once. I accepted that and proposed an email workflow using n8n. Donna would compose and send a message while introducing itself as my assistant. However, I had to correct the project's status. My old workflow worked, but it is broken since I updated my system. The rebuild is a next step, not something I have already completed. That correction matters because my portfolio should describe what works now, what used to work, and what I am still trying to achieve.

I checked the AI's observation that a successful demonstration does not establish continued reliability against my own experience. A previously working integration stopped working after a system change. I accept the observation, but the exchange did not diagnose the cause. It also did not prove that a new approach would be faster or more efficient. Those are questions to test during the rebuild, rather than results I can claim now.

The most useful disagreement concerned how I learn. The AI asked whether reliability and understanding should come before optimization. I said that reliability matters, but I did not fully understand the distinction in its question. Much of my understanding comes from researching, rebuilding, making mistakes, and finding where I went wrong. I do not build randomly. I research first, then try things, and still encounter failures because I experiment a lot. The AI's framing was too simple: building and understanding do not happen in separate stages for me. Its revised recommendation should support learning through construction while keeping track of the mistakes and their fixes.

I also challenged the suggestion that digital workflows might be too far from my home-assistant ambition. They feel like its foundations. The two scenarios can therefore share an initial email project while leading toward different work: software workflow integration or integration involving physical devices and home systems. The second remains more speculative because my hardware troubleshooting does not demonstrate complete smart-home integration skills.

My decision is to clarify automation as my primary direction and investigate a bounded email-workflow rebuild. I will keep the existing programming, testing, and documentation gaps instead of raising my ratings without evidence. My portfolio remains the place to explain the work. Digital workflow integration is the scenario worth examining first. One unresolved question is which actual roles value the combination I want to develop: my earlier creative-technology advertisements only partly answer it. I can retain the broader ambition while using research, working examples, and recorded failures to make the next step more concrete.

5. Two conditional career scenarios

Horizon: Three to five years from this exchange, approximately 2029-2031. These scenarios are AI-assisted speculation for testing, not predictions, invented vacancies, or claims of qualification.

Scenario A: Digital workflow integration

Possible trajectory: Begin with personal email and task workflows, then develop portfolio evidence for work integrating software processes for a team or organization. The emphasis would be understanding data flow, connecting services, handling failures, and explaining the result. An eventual role or suitable entry route remains to be researched.

Supported observations: I prefer automation and integration, have configured AI tools, and previously had a working email workflow. My 1b comparison includes prototype and integration tasks [J1-J3], but Amazon specifically requires front-end experience and coding samples [J2]. That advertisement is not evidence of an automation-only role.

Assumptions: A documented rebuild could become useful portfolio evidence. I could improve my programming and testing through repeated small projects. Some future organizations may value this combination, but the existing sample does not establish that market fit.

Conditions, gaps, and evidence needed: Rebuild one bounded workflow explain its inputs, outputs, service connections, and failures record normal and failure tests distinguish my contribution from AI assistance. Peer or instructor feedback could help assess the explanation. Later role research must identify relevant qualifications and eligibility rather than assume them.

Questions for future research: Which real roles best match this work? What programming depth and project evidence do they expect? Does a revised workflow actually improve reliability, time, or cost?

Scenario B: Home and physical-system integration

Possible trajectory: Use the same digital foundation, then investigate work connecting assistants with physical devices and environments. Compared with Scenario A, the work would involve device behavior and the physical setting as well as software workflows. My own home would be a possible learning context, not proof of a business or career outcome.

Supported observations: A home assistant is my stated long-term ambition. My 1c SWOT records PC/controller troubleshooting and modification as practical strengths. My earlier research identifies physical computing as an optional direction in one creative-technology example [J3] that does not establish a smart-home career pathway.

Assumptions: Troubleshooting habits could transfer to device integration after further learning. Small device experiments could extend the digital foundation. Sustained time, access to compatible equipment, and suitable opportunities are uncertain.

Conditions, gaps, and evidence needed: Demonstrate a dependable digital workflow before adding a limited device interaction. Learn the relevant device interfaces and failure behavior. Document user control, recovery, and what happens when a connection is unavailable. Hardware familiarity alone would not demonstrate these capabilities. Feedback from someone with relevant technical experience would help evaluate the work.

Questions for future research: Which roles or fields actually connect these interests? What additional device and systems knowledge would they require? Could the work fit my time and budget without assuming immediate purchases or a complete home system?

6. Framework decision and source record

Decision about the existing framework and visuals

This document records a clarification of my strategy: automation and integration are the primary interest, the portfolio supports presentation, and rebuilding the broken email workflow is the proposed first project. The previous framework and 1c visuals stand as the documented starting point. Their programming, testing, and documentation gaps remain relevant. I have not redrawn them or raised any ratings because no new competence or completed replacement workflow was demonstrated in this exchange. The next version can reflect evidence from the rebuild and more relevant role research. My original 1a is not overwritten.

Bring to class: Scenario A, digital workflow integration, and the question: which actual roles value this combination of assistant development, integration, and practical testing?

Step useful across both scenarios: Research and rebuild Donna's email workflow, then document tests, failures, and explanations. The scenarios share that foundation but change the technical environment and the work I would need to demonstrate.

Employer evidence and existing Zotero records

The following sources were included in 1b/1c and are linked to their existing shared-course Zotero records. The earlier research date is October 7, 2026. Amazon's original advertisement was rechecked during the October 12 exchange. This source list does not claim that all advertisements remain open or that their requirements predict future demand.

- **J1. Kyndryl, Associate Creative Technologist, R-66763.** Original advertisement | Zotero item L6497K6M.
- **J2. Amazon, Design Technologist II, Prime Video, 10507619.** Original advertisement | Zotero item A78V4Y46.
- **J3. NEXT/NOW, Creative Technologist AI.** Original advertisement | Zotero item Y5J58NT5.
- **J4. Kyndryl, Senior Lead Creative Technologist, R-64636.** Original advertisement | Zotero item 8WANR6DV.

Course instruction: Assignment 1d: AI Collaboration and Career Futures.

Personal evidence: My October 12 report of the broken workflow and October 14 explanation of my learning approach, quoted in Sections 2-3. These are first-hand statements, not independently inspected logs or measured results.

AI use acknowledgment

I used OpenAI ChatGPT/Codex, addressed as Donna, on October 12 and 14, 2026 to question my strategy, explore conditional scenarios, examine source fit, organize the exchange, and help draft and format this document from my answers. The exact model version was not retained in the exchange record. My quoted responses are my own the scenarios and recommendations are AI-assisted. The AI response is interaction evidence, not a verified source of job-market facts. My corrections about the workflow, my preferred direction, and how I learn guide the analysis and decision.